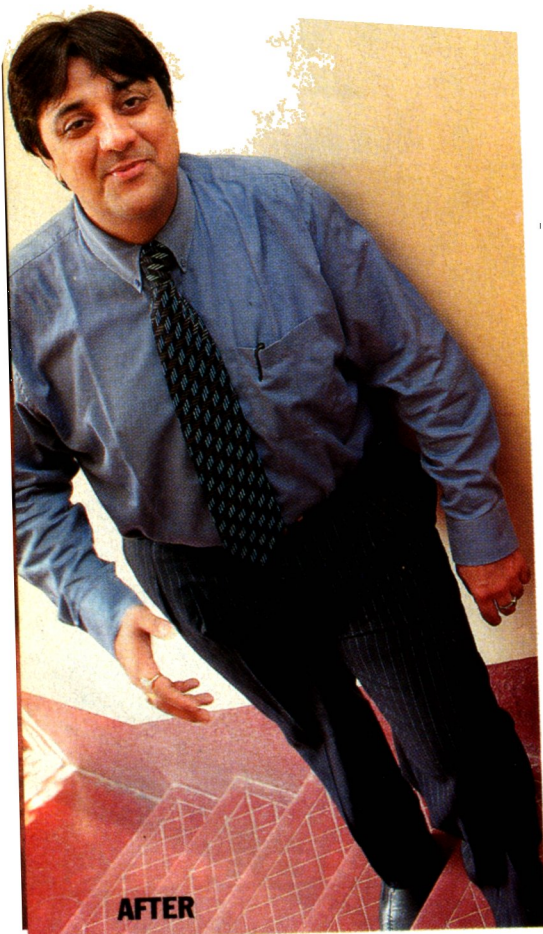


SANDIP KAPUR BODY CONTOURING

His job is to train corporates and insurance agents. An alumni of La Martiniere, Kolkata, and Hindu College, Delhi, he spent a whole decade after graduation trying to consolidate his family business. His first foray into the corporate world made him realise the importance of looking good. "I could see people were shying away from me because at 115 kg, I looked overbearing," he says. He started gymming regularly, but realised that they didn't make him lose a lot of weight. This year, he went in for body contouring. Ten litres of fat have been removed from his tummy, sides and face. "Now that the inches have gone I feel like a million bucks," he smiles.



The Cost of Looking Good

Most popular procedures that men opt for...

ABDOMINAL CONTOURING: Young males who have lost weight through excessive dieting or gymming but are left with loose skinfolds requiring surgical removal. Roughly 15 per cent of men go under the knife for these. **Rs 70,000 to Rs 80,000**

NOSE JOB: Rhinoplasty tops the makeover list. It now draws as many males as females. Involves sculpting the nose, reshaping and harmonising the face. North Indian men often have noses out of proportion to their face. **Rs 40,000 to Rs 45,000**

BREAST REDUCTION: Enlarged breast is the bane of Indian men. Reason? Sedentary lifestyles and low fitness regimes or hormonal changes during puberty lead to fatty accumulation. At least 50 per cent of the clientele goes for it. **Rs 40,000**

CHIN AUGMENTATION: An increasingly

popular cosmetic surgery for getting a stronger and well-defined chin and squarish jawline. Involves putting in a small synthetic implant over the natural bone to create a more suitable chin. **Rs 40,000 to Rs 50,000**

EYELID LIFT: For older men. Gives a youthful look, improves eyelid function. Surgery corrects sagging or drooping eyelids and/or bags and bulges around the eyes, by removing excess skin and fat, if necessary. **Rs 35,000 to Rs 40,000**

FACIAL REJUVENATION: Done in three-steps. The first is cream treatment, next chemical peel, and the third is laser treatment. **Rs 70,000 to Rs 75,000**

HAIR TRANSPLANTATION: A procedure in which hair is grafted from some other part of the body on to the scalp. Success depends on the area of the scalp that has lost hair. **Rs 5,000 for 10 grafts**, each graft measuring 4-5 mm in diameter.

mere doing away with excess fat," points out Murthy. She is increasingly facing more demands for such treatments which include nose correction, breast reduction, hair restoration, eyelid correction, facelift and facial rejuvenation. Consider Jugal Bansal, 60. He was working for a public sector unit in 2001 when his wife noticed a crease between his eyes that made him look "angry". He got even with his wrinkles—he went to a plastic surgeon to get the first of six Botox injections. "I felt more confident after I had it done," says Bansal, who is now retired and about to have a facelift. "If there's a nice way to remedy the effects of ageing, then I say, 'Why not?'"

Life is looking good all over again for Sriram Iyer of Chennai. Early this year, the 31-year-old software professional had to travel to Chicago to make a technical presentation to an American

client. With a Masters in Computer Science from the University of Southern California, Los Angeles, Iyer wasn't worried about impressing the client with his technical prowess. But he was seriously concerned about his expanding waistline, gaunt face and the dark rings under his eyes. Four weeks before the trip, he decided to take matters in hand. "I was a bit apprehensive initially," reveals Iyer, who underwent an abdominoplasty (to deal with localised, exercise-resistant fat deposits, loosened and excessive muscles) and a fat transfer (to correct the nasojugal groove under the lower eyelids). "But I was sure I wanted to look good." Becoming 70 kg on a six-foot frame, Iyer is now flaunting a perfectly ironed-out face and stomach. "I love wearing T-shirts, but my girth used to make me feel terribly self-conscious," he remembers. He is once again adding to his collection of Tees and is now looking for a life partner.

In a fast-evolving world of demand and supply, statistics are rare. But Dr Sunil Choudhury, who heads the department of plastic & reconstructive surgery at Max Healthcare, Delhi, is

"A majority of our patients are the affluent middle class; they are driving the boom."

DR S.S. SAHA, DELHI